INDIA MANUFACTURING & SOURCING DATA API

Complete business ecosystem, supplier onboarding, consent and commercialisation, campaigns, technology, competition, and launch roadmap

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Starting asset: 1,200 supplier records across multiple Indian states. The source, permissions, completeness and verification status of these records are not yet established.

Decision summary

Build an API-first supplier intelligence business, supported by a free supplier self-registration portal and a simple buyer discovery experience. Do not promise leads before buyer demand exists. Do not resell personal contact data without an appropriate lawful basis and clearly documented permissions. Validate paid buyer demand before heavy development.

This document is a strategic plan, not legal, tax or financial advice. Examples, targets, prices and budgets are illustrative unless a source is provided.

1 | Business thesis and differentiation

- Supply side: manufacturers, contract manufacturers, job workers, raw-material suppliers, component vendors, exporters, distributors and sourcing/buying houses register and update profiles.
- Demand side: procurement SaaS, B2B marketplaces, ERP vendors, sourcing agencies and enterprise sourcing teams pay for API access, enrichment or licensed exports.
- Value proposition to suppliers: a free, claimable, accurate business profile and potential discovery by qualified buyers; no guaranteed inquiries.
- Value proposition to API buyers: structured searchable coverage, freshness dates, manufacturing capabilities, verification evidence, consistent IDs and clear redistribution terms.
- Initial wedge: one category and geographic cluster where you have the most complete records; expand only after usage and retention justify it.

2 | Ecosystem map and roles

Layer	Participants / workflows
Supplier entities	Factory owner, manufacturer, OEM/ODM, private-label producer, contract manufacturer, job-work unit, industrial component producer, raw-material supplier, distributor, exporter.
Sourcing intermediaries	Buying house, sourcing agent, procurement consultant, quality inspection firm, exporter aggregator; distinguish non-factory intermediaries from factory owners.
Buyer organisations	Procurement SaaS, ERP, B2B marketplace, sourcing agency, enterprise buyer, exporter/importer, business intelligence firm.
Trust infrastructure	Business registration checks, supplier-submitted evidence, certificate validation, moderation, dispute and correction workflows.
Product channels	Supplier claim portal, public limited directory, private buyer dashboard, paid API, licensed bulk export, webhook updates.
Operations	Supplier acquisition, support, verification, sales, security, billing, legal, data quality, customer success.

3 | Industry taxonomy: what belongs in the database

Use NIC 2025 for formal activity classification, plus your own searchable commercial hierarchy: sector > industry > subindustry > product/service > specifications. Keep NIC version and code; maintain mappings to NIC 2008 when necessary. NIC 2025 uses six-digit subclass codes. [S1]

Sector families	Illustrative product and service branches
Food, agriculture, beverages	Namkeen, snacks, spices, bakery, dairy, edible oils, grain milling, frozen foods, beverages, contract packing.
Textiles and apparel	Rugs, carpets, yarn, weaving, dyeing, fabrics, garments, home furnishings, garment sourcing houses.
Building materials	Tiles, ceramic and vitrified tiles, sanitaryware, bricks, fly-ash bricks, AAC blocks, cement, precast concrete, pavers, glass, stone, marble, granite.
Metals and engineering	Steel, aluminium, foundries, casting, forging, fasteners, CNC machining, gears, shafts, precision parts, fabrication.
Machines and electrical	Industrial machinery, pumps, compressors, packaging lines, transformers, motors, switchgear, cables, automation.
Automotive and mobility	Auto components, EV parts, batteries, railway equipment, ship components, aerospace parts.
Chemicals and polymers	Chemicals, paints, adhesives, resins, plastic moulding, rubber products, industrial coatings.
Healthcare and consumer	Pharma, medical devices, cosmetics, personal care, furniture, footwear, leather, toys, jewellery.
Packaging, paper and print	Corrugated boxes, labels, flexible packaging, paperboard, bottles, printing, pallets.
Industrial services	Testing, certification, tooling, maintenance, heat treatment, coating, inspection, recycling and recovery.

These are commercial discovery families, not an exhaustive legal classification. Sourcing, trading and services may fall outside manufacturing NIC classes. A company may have multiple roles and products.

4 | Canonical supplier data model

Entity	Essential attributes
Company	Stable company ID, legal/trade name, entity type, roles, status, website, description, incorporation/establishment year, NIC codes.
Facility	Facility ID, registered office/factory/warehouse role, address, city, state, PIN, approximate geolocation, facility status.
Product	Canonical product category, aliases, brand, materials, sizes, application, standards, customisation, SKU where available.
Capability	Processes, machinery, tolerances, output units, capacity and date, supported materials, OEM/ODM, private label, job-work.
Commercial	MOQ and unit, indicative lead time, export destinations, markets served, RFQ channel; quotes are dated, not evergreen prices.
Compliance	Certificate type, issuer, scope, document reference, expiry, verification state; never mark verified without evidence.
Contact	Official business email, generic phone, contact person if permitted, visibility tier, provenance, consent/rights state.
Provenance	Source URL or supplier submission, collection time, last verification, evidence, rights, allowed uses, retention policy.
Platform	Supplier user accounts, claim events, consent versions, changes, audit logs, API customers, keys, usage and invoices.

Specialised fields by industry

- Rugs: weaving method, pile, composition, sizes, dyes, finishing, export and private-label capabilities.
- Namkeen: FSSAI licence details as appropriate, product type, packaging, shelf life, allergens, batch capacity and food-safety evidence.
- Tiles/bricks: ceramic/vitrified/fly-ash/clay/AAC, grade, dimensions, thickness, water absorption, compressive strength, relevant test reports.
- Machined components: machining process, material, tolerance, equipment, inspection instruments, minimum batch and drawings policy.
- Sourcing houses: sourcing categories, represented regions, factory network, QC services, buyer geographies, whether they own facilities.

5 | Supplier registration and claim journey

Acquisition page -> choose role -> verify business email/phone -> create account -> accept platform terms and privacy notice -> select publication and commercial API permissions -> enter company details -> add facilities, products and capabilities -> upload optional evidence -> moderation -> publish permitted fields -> periodic refresh.

- Offer a two-minute basic registration and a deeper optional profile; allow save-and-return.

- Do not require Aadhaar or sensitive identity documents for ordinary listing; collect only what is necessary.
- Separate consent for: (a) public business profile, (b) commercial API distribution of specified fields, (c) marketing messages, and (d) optional buyer introductions. Avoid bundling these into one mandatory checkbox.
- Record consent text/version, timestamp, source, actor, purpose, field scope and withdrawal history.
- Give suppliers preview, edit, correction, delisting and contact preference controls; explain how downstream API licensees handle updates.
- Claiming an existing record requires verification of authority to represent that business; do not let an unverified claimant overwrite a profile.

Suggested registration form

Step	Fields
1. Identity	Business name, business role(s), company website, business email, city/state, authorised representative.
2. Discovery	Primary industry, products/services, manufacturing processes, business description, keywords.
3. Capability	Factory locations, materials, OEM/ODM, private label, MOQ, lead time, capacity and units, export markets.
4. Trust	Optional GSTIN/Udyam references, licence/certificate details, evidence, last verified date.
5. Permissions	Public fields, licensed API fields, contact sharing, marketing opt-in, rights declaration, terms acceptance.

6 | Commercial permissions and legal risk controls

Crucial distinction: business facts can be public, but an individual owner's name, mobile number and email may constitute personal data. Public availability alone does not automatically grant unrestricted copying, resale, outreach or API redistribution. India's DPDP Act/Rules have phased implementation; obtain current Indian counsel review of your collection, notice, lawful basis, rights, breach and deletion processes. [S2]

- Inventory all existing 1,200 records by original source, collection method, permissions and restrictions before uploading or monetising.
- Use a supplier participation agreement granting a defined, revocable or terminable licence to display and distribute specified submitted business data to commercial API customers; define sublicensing limits, corrections and termination.
- Separate intellectual-property rights for logos, catalogues, photographs and certificates; supplier must have authority to provide them.
- Avoid implying government endorsement, guaranteed leads or official verification where none exists.
- Create a privacy notice, platform terms, supplier data licence, API customer agreement, acceptable-use policy, retention/deletion policy, incident response plan and complaint contact.
- API customer contracts should prohibit unsolicited spam, unlawful profiling, reidentification, bulk republication beyond licence and onward resale unless explicitly authorised.
- Handle withdrawal carefully: stop future distribution, update caches and notify downstream clients according to contract and applicable law; acknowledge that already-exported copies need contractual controls.
- Keep evidence of consent/contract and data provenance. Encrypt data, use least-privilege access, rate limits and access logs.

Example permission language - drafting starting point only

"I confirm I am authorised to submit this business information. I permit [Platform] to publish the business fields I select and, separately if I opt in, license the selected fields through paid business data APIs to approved customers for supplier discovery and procurement use. I can request corrections or withdraw applicable permissions through my dashboard. Personal contact details will be shared only under the separate contact-sharing selection."

This is sample wording, not a legally sufficient consent notice or supplier agreement. Have a qualified lawyer adapt it to your precise processing and applicable law.

7 | Supplier value proposition and offer design

Supplier objection	Honest response / feature
"Why register?"	Free searchable company profile, structured capability showcase and visibility to potential sourcing software users.
"Will I get orders?"	No guaranteed leads; show actual profile views, enquiries and qualified introductions once they exist.
"Will you sell my number?"	Field-level publication/API permissions; default to generic business channels; clear buyer usage restrictions.
"I am already on IndiaMART"	This is an additional API-powered discovery channel, not a replacement; niche and integration-focused.
"It takes too long"	Two-minute basic form, optional assisted onboarding and later profile completion.
"What if details change?"	Self-service editing, correction support and periodic verification reminders.

8 | Acquisition campaigns: 90-day playbook

Campaign A: claim your factory profile

Audience: the 1,200 existing suppliers where you have a lawful basis to contact them. Message: "We are building a structured Indian manufacturer discovery network. Check whether your business is listed, correct details, and choose what may be shared with business software customers." Avoid implying they already consented.

Campaign B: cluster-specific recruitment

Select one industrial cluster and one vertical (for example, Panipat rugs, Morbi tiles, or a precision machining cluster). Create tailored landing pages and industry-specific capability forms. Approach local trade associations for permission-based introductions.

Campaign C: partner-assisted onboarding

Work with associations, incubators, industry consultants, export promotion groups and quality-service partners. Offer co-branded workshops on digital supplier profiles. Avoid paying for unverified or fabricated signups.

Campaign D: content and SEO

Publish useful non-spam pages such as "How to evaluate a vitrified tile manufacturer" and "CNC supplier qualification checklist". Invite relevant suppliers to claim profiles. Publish only permitted, useful information.

Campaign E: targeted paid experiments

Test small, measurable search/social budgets for specific clusters. Track verified profile completion and permission quality, not just form submissions. Stop campaigns with poor quality.

Channel	Pilot test	Primary KPI
Existing-record outreach	100 eligible, carefully reviewed contacts; personalised email/phone outreach where lawful	Claimed and verified profiles / eligible contacts
Association partnership	2-3 relevant associations or cluster groups	Qualified introductions and completed profiles
LinkedIn outreach	50 founder-led messages to authorised business representatives	Positive replies and meetings
SEO/content	4 category pages and 4 practical guides	Qualified supplier registrations
Paid search	Small capped experiment; one cluster/category	Cost per verified, licensed profile

9 | Outreach scripts you can use

Supplier email

Subject: Free manufacturer profile - verify your business details
Hello, we are building a searchable Indian manufacturing supplier directory for sourcing and procurement software. We would like to invite [Company] to create or claim a free profile showing its products and manufacturing capabilities. You can review what is public, separately choose whether selected business information may be licensed through our commercial API, and edit or request removal of your details. We do not promise orders or sell personal contact details without appropriate permission. Would you like the registration link?

Short WhatsApp message - only where outreach is permitted

Hello, I am building a manufacturing supplier discovery platform for Indian businesses. We are inviting [category] manufacturers to register a free profile and choose how their business details can be shown or licensed. May I share the registration link?

Trade association partnership pitch

We would like to run a free digital supplier-profile workshop for your members, helping them describe products, capabilities and certifications in a standard format. Participation and commercial API sharing permissions will be optional and transparent. Could we discuss a pilot with 20 member businesses?

API buyer discovery message

We are developing a permission-based supplier discovery API focused on [category/region], with company profiles, capabilities, locations and verification timestamps. Are you currently building or maintaining supplier data inside your procurement product? We would value 15 minutes to understand your required fields, coverage and data licensing needs.

10 | Buyer discovery and commercial validation

- Interview at least 20 prospective API buyers: procurement SaaS, ERP vendors, sourcing platforms and B2B marketplaces.

- Ask for exact workflow, category/region coverage, missing fields, monthly searches, update frequency, required API uptime and permitted use cases.
- Show a 50-100 record licensed sample with realistic completeness and freshness indicators; never overstate coverage.
- Offer paid pilots with written scope: category, number of records, API quota, fields, allowed uses, support and correction SLA.
- Prioritise a buyer who will pay for a narrow dataset over dozens of vague expressions of interest.

11 | API product and technical architecture

Suggested MVP stack: PostgreSQL + FastAPI or Node.js, managed hosting, object storage for permitted evidence, Redis for rate limiting, a queue for verification jobs, a simple supplier portal and admin review panel. Use one maintainable application initially, not microservices.

Endpoint	Purpose
GET /v1/suppliers	Filter by role, product, capability, city, state, verification state; paginate.
GET /v1/suppliers/{id}	Return allowed profile fields, data freshness and evidence metadata.
GET /v1/categories	Return commercial taxonomy and NIC mappings.
GET /v1/locations	Supported regions and coverage counts.
POST /v1/feedback	Buyer correction reports and data-quality flags.
GET /v1/changes	Changes since timestamp for licensed customers.
POST /supplier/profile	Authenticated supplier submission/update workflow.

Architecture controls

- Separate public, licensed and restricted fields; apply field-level authorisation before serialisation.
- Keep API keys hashed, with per-client quotas, scopes, usage logs, revocation and billing.
- Publish API documentation, examples, status/error codes, versioning and deprecation policy.
- Normalise company identities, deduplicate by multiple signals and never assume matching names mean the same entity.
- Provide timestamps and provenance; distinguish supplier-claimed, documentary-verified and independently-verified claims.
- Use webhooks or change feeds later; do not promise real-time data without an actual refresh mechanism.

12 | Competitive landscape and market positioning

Existing player	Observed offering	Your positioning question
IndiaMART	Large Indian B2B supplier discovery and lead marketplace.	Can you provide more precise structured, licensed niche data rather than compete on directory size?
TradeIndia	B2B marketplace, supplier listings and trade leads. [S3]	Can your integration-first product solve software vendor needs?
Kompass India	Company search, B2B lists and supplier discovery; self-serve data exports. [S4]	Can you beat niche data freshness, coverage and API ease?
Thomasnet	Industrial sourcing and supplier discovery, US-oriented.	Can you localise detailed manufacturing capability profiles for India?
Specialised data brokers	Custom B2B lists, company enrichment and exports.	Can you demonstrate lawful field rights and ongoing maintenance?

Competitive claims about public API availability and current prices require direct sales confirmation; do not assume that a directory sells a self-service supplier API. The market is competitive, and differentiation remains a hypothesis until buyer interviews validate it.

13 | Revenue model and unit economics

Product	Illustrative pricing experiment	Key restriction
Pilot dataset / API	INR 2,000-10,000 one-time	Fixed category, fields, permitted use, duration.
Starter API	INR 1,999-4,999/month	Low quota, restricted fields and support.
Growth API	INR 9,999-24,999/month	Higher quota, richer fields and updates.
Enterprise licence	Custom contract	Volume, SLAs, audit and redistribution terms.
Supplier premium tools	Consider later	Never make commercial data permission a condition of a free profile.

These are test prices, not market benchmarks. Track customer acquisition cost, gross margin, verification cost per supplier, renewal/churn, API usage, data freshness and conversion to paid pilots. Revenue examples: 5 customers at INR 4,999/month = INR 24,995 MRR; 20 = INR 99,980 MRR, before costs and taxes.

Illustrative lean 3-month cash budget

Expense	Planning range (INR)
Domain, hosting, email, basic software	5,000-20,000
Supplier verification and outreach	15,000-60,000
Design, forms, legal review, policies	20,000-80,000
Content and pilot campaigns	10,000-40,000
Contingency	10,000-30,000
Total planning envelope	60,000-230,000

Budget excludes founder salary and any full-time hires; actual costs can differ greatly. Spend in stages only after validating buyer demand.

14 | Supplier onboarding funnel and metrics

Track: eligible invitations -> reached -> registration started -> completed -> authority checked -> field permissions recorded -> verified -> published -> updated within 90 days. Example pilot: 200 eligible invitations, 60 starts, 40 completions, 25 approved profiles = 12.5% approved per invitation. These are sample funnel figures, not predictions.

- North-star supply metric: number of active, sufficiently complete, permissioned supplier profiles in your chosen niche.
- North-star demand metric: recurring paying API customers receiving measurable sourcing value.
- Quality: duplicate rate, contact bounce rate, verification age, correction turnaround and coverage by category.
- Commercial: pilot-to-paid conversion, monthly recurring revenue, gross margin, retention and acquisition payback.

15 | 12-month phased execution roadmap

Timing	Deliverables / gate
Weeks 1-2	Audit 1,200 records; rights/provenance matrix; pick one niche; interview 10 buyers.
Weeks 3-4	Supplier landing page, two-minute form, field permissions, basic admin moderation; 20 more buyer interviews.
Month 2	Recruit 50-100 permissioned, high-quality niche profiles; run 2 association/cluster tests; private API prototype.
Month 3	Deliver 2-3 buyer evaluations and aim for 1 paid pilot; measure completeness and accuracy.
Months 4-6	Improve category schema, verification operations, API documentation, billing, support and change feed.
Months 7-9	Expand to adjacent categories/clusters only when first niche has repeat usage and renewals.
Months 10-12	Evaluate sales repeatability, data licensing risk, unit economics and next hiring/partnership decisions.

16 | Risk register and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
No buyers for API	Sell a small paid data pilot before major engineering; ask buyers what they will pay for.
Suppliers do not register	Free value, short form, trust-building, assisted onboarding, industry partnerships.
Poor data quality	Verification evidence, timestamps, automated checks, correction workflows, periodic refresh.
Privacy/licensing complaints	Field-level permissions, source inventory, counsel review, takedown and downstream obligations.
Low dataset coverage	Concentrate on one niche/cluster; disclose coverage and unknowns.
Misrepresentation of verification	Distinct self-declared/document-checked/independently verified statuses.
Data scraping / bulk theft	Authentication, quotas, anomaly detection, contractual controls; no absolute prevention claim.
High acquisition cost	Founder-led outbound and association channels before large paid campaigns.

17 | Launch checklist

- [ ] Choose a brand, domain, positioning statement and narrow target industry.
- [ ] Audit source and permission status for every one of the 1,200 records.
- [ ] Design category hierarchy and canonical company/product/facility model.
- [ ] Publish clear supplier registration terms, privacy notice and field-level choices.
- [ ] Build company claim and verification process, admin review and correction handling.
- [ ] Prepare 100 high-quality, lawfully usable sample records.
- [ ] Recruit 20-50 suppliers through an industry-specific campaign.
- [ ] Conduct 20 buyer discovery interviews; secure at least one paid pilot.
- [ ] Build API keys, rate limiting, logging, documentation and usage controls.
- [ ] Monitor data accuracy, support tickets, customer usage and renewal intent.

18 | Founder decisions to make now

1. What is the original source and reuse permission for your 1,200 records? 2. Which industry has the highest concentration and richest fields? 3. Which fields can be published publicly, licensed via API, or kept restricted? 4. Can you reach 20 procurement software buyers? 5. What is the smallest paid pilot you can deliver in 30 days?

19 | Sources and further reading

[S1] MoSPI / PIB, NIC 2025 release (18 Nov 2025)
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2191142

[S1b] NIC 2025 full classification PDF
https://www.mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/main_menu/national_industrial_classification/NIC_2025Final_18112025.pdf

[S2] MeitY DPDP Rules 2025 and enforcement timeline
https://www.meity.gov.in/documents/act-and-policies/digital-personal-data-protection-rules-2025-gDOxUjMtQWa?pageTitle=Digital-

Personal-Data-Protection-Rules-2025-2

[S2b] PIB DPDP Rules announcement
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2190014

[S3] TradeIndia marketplace
https://www.tradeindia.com/

[S4] Kompass India data and discovery offerings
https://kompassindia.com/

[S5] Udyam official registration information
https://www.udyamregistration.gov.in/Important.aspx

[S6] Thomasnet supplier discovery
https://www.thomasnet.com/

Prepared for business planning. Verify current regulatory requirements, vendor API terms and competitor product claims before launch.